MURAL

Team Number 3

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Upskilling & Networking System

CANVAS 4 - BSMS4002
DESIGN THINKING FOR DATA-DRIVEN APP DEVELOPMENT

CAREER BRIDGE

EMPATHIZE (2) • ANALYZE (2) • SOLVE (2) • NEW CHALLENGES

New Challenges

Jira Link.

Enhancing Interactive Recruitment: Recruiters want to move beyond static resume reviews. They require tools like a "interact with the resume" feature and bulk email messaging to make the hiring process more dynamic and efficient. The challenge is to integrate these interactive elements with robust analytics and filters for role-based selection.
Delivering Personalized Skill Improvement: Students need more than generic guidance. They want personalized feedback on their resumes through an ATS score, conversational AI quiz feedback to work on weak sections, and a clear visualization of their strengths and weaknesses in both technical and non-technical areas.
Fostering a Collaborative Community: Students desire a platform where they can interact with and learn from their peers. The challenge is to build a vibrant community dashboard that encourages interactive communication and collaboration, moving beyond a simple forum to a dynamic learning ecosystem.
Improving User Onboarding and Feature Discoverability: Users found that while the app's design was clean, it was not always intuitive. Several users told us they struggled with knowing where to start when they first opened the app. They also mentioned that some important features were hard to find. The challenge is to improve the user experience by creating a clear onboarding process .

Customer Journey Map(Revised)

CJM Jira Link

Customer Journey Map 1 (Soumyadeep Mondal, Commerce Graduate)

- **Before:** Soumyadeep has finished his degree but is concerned and uncertain about his career path. He updates his resume and searches for jobs on Linkedin, feeling that his professional network is weak and he lacks clarity on in-demand industry skills.
- **During:** Soumyadeep uses our application to see his **daily progress** and do **self-paced courses in Finance** . He interacts with mentors for help and builds projects to acquire **skills in BFSI sector**.He gets these projects verified by mentors and applies for jobs. He can also see the different stages of his application process.
- **After:** He finds that the application provided a good foundation, but he still needs to work on his weaknesses.He uses the platform's **AI quiz feedback and conversation** to improve on weak sections and feels that **UI/UX changes** can make the app feel more realistic and professional.

Customer Journey Map 2 (Divyanshi Mathur, Final Year Student)

- **Before:** Divyanshi feels unsure but optimistic, armed with strong academics and extracurriculars.Her pain point is a difficulty translating her leadership experience into industry-specific terms. She is frustrated that her academic excellence isn't enough to get interviews.
- **During:** She participates in a **soft skills simulation** to practice teamwork and communication, receiving instant feedback. She also uses the **community dashboard** to collaborate on projects with peers.
- **After:** Divyanshi feels confident in her ability to adapt to professional culture. She uses the platform's insights into her **strengths and weaknesses** in technical and non-technical areas to continually improve her skills. The **community dashboard** helps her interact with other students and she finds the updated **UI/UX** more user-friendly.

Customer Journey Map 3 (Prem Kumar, IIT M Graduate)

- **Before:** Prem recognizes the challenge of standing out among a competitive peer group.He feels a disconnect between his academic projects and the complexity of real-world problems.
- **During:** Prem enrolls in our application's **mentor led sessions where researchers provide him detailed guidance** and help him build projects to improve his skills. He interacts with mentors for help to clarify his doubts.
- **After:** Prem secures a job as **Project Associate in IIT Bombay** and attributes his success to the application's emphasis on practical projects and mentor feedback. He still feels the need to better integrate his research credentials with industry needs, a feature he hopes our application will eventually provide. He uses the platform to continue his **upskilling** journey.

Customer Journey Map 4 (Ishan Das Sharma, CTO, Voxxi labs)

- **Before:** Ishan notices hiring delays due to underprepared hires and a chronic shortage of job-ready candidates.
- **During:** Ishan uses our application to **post jobs** and get **AI feedback on candidate resumes** . He sees a **candidate fit score** for each job and uses **various filters** to narrow down his search. He schedules and conducts interviews through our platform and receives updates on the stages of each application.
- **After:** Ishan measures the ramp-up time for new hires and finds it to be significantly reduced. He is pleased with the platform's ability to help him find better candidates, but he suggests adding more detailed **analytics/graphs** and a **bulk email message** option for individual candidates.

Customer Journey Map 5 (Aastha Awasthi, HR)

- **Before:** Aastha struggles with hiring inefficiency and the challenge of filtering for serious candidates. She finds it hard to judge non-technical skills.
- **During:** Aastha uses our application to **post jobs** and get **AI feedback on candidate resumes**. She sees a **candidate fit score** for each job and uses **various filters** to narrow down her search. She schedules and conducts interviews through our platform. She also uses our platform to conduct one-on-one sessions and group sessions with candidates.
- **After:** Aastha finds that the quality of candidates has improved and her time spent on screening has decreased. She wishes the platform offered an embedded feedback system to provide more efficient feedback to applicants, and she asks for a **"Interact with the resume"** feature to make the process even more interactive.

Customer Journey Map 6 (Amit Kumar, Aspiring Food Technologist)

- **Before:** Amit struggles to showcase his non-technical skills, as academic programs focus only on technical skills. He needs virtual internships and a way to build his network.
- **During:** Amit uses the application to create a **standardized digital portfolio** that highlights his projects and soft skills. He participates in a **soft skills simulation** and receives feedback, helping him understand how to present his skills effectively. He joins a **peer group** based on his learning stage to get peer reviews on his projects
- **After:** Amit is more confident in presenting his skills. He feels the application successfully helped him bridge the gap between his technical knowledge and the non-technical skills needed in the workplace. He suggests adding a feature to show his**strengths and weaknesses in technical and non-technical areas**.

Customer Journey Map 7(Prostab Kundu, Mentor, AI Engineer)

- **Before:** Prostab is a mentor who needs to balance upskilling with his work. He is looking for a platform that makes his contributions easy and impactful.
- **During:** Prostab becomes a mentor on our platform and uses it to conduct **one-to-one sessions as well as group sessions**. He can also **clarify doubts in the chat section**. He guides students on building projects and verifying their skills, and provides overall feedback on their progress.
- **After:** Prostab is able to mentor students effectively without a significant time commitment. He is pleased with the platform but suggests creating a more robust system for ongoing upskilling and sustained network engagement. He would like to see a feature that incentivizes mentors more directly.

Customer Journey Map 8 (Prostab Kundu, Mentor, AI Engineer)

- **Before:** Jivraj realizes internship season is approaching and sees his peers succeed via an application. His pain point is limited exposure to production tooling.
- **During:**Jivraj enrolls in a pilot track that integrates live projects and simulations into the upskilling path. He completes micro-courses and presents a capstone project to a mentor. He uses the application's UI/UX changes, which have a better contrast and size, making it feel more realistic.
- **After:** Jivraj tracks recruiter views and gets a job offer. He is happy with the platform's ability to help him get exposure to real-world tools, but he believes there's still a gap in how academia prioritizes publications over industry relevance. He suggests adding an **ATS score and improving resume tips** to further boost overall job readiness.

How Might We (HMW)?

Jira Link

How might we create a platform that allows recruiters to dynamically assess candidates beyond static resumes, offering features like a "interact with the resume" tool and advanced analytics for specific roles?

How might we design a system that provides students with a personalized roadmap to success, including an **ATS score**, conversational **AI quiz feedback**, and a clear profile of their **strengths and weaknesses**?

How might we foster a vibrant community where students can easily connect with peers and mentors, creating a **collaborative environment** for learning and professional growth?

How might we improve our application's **user onboarding and UI/UX** to help users discover key features and provide a clear, intuitive starting point that makes the app feel professional and trustworthy?

Prototype Link:

https://www.figma.com/design/UWPuM2MhODNdGnqQ6T1NBD/DT_Team-03?node-id=1-9046&m=dev&t=oGSo7F4A-1

Multi Why Analysis

Jira Link

Inefficient and Impersonal Hiring Process

Why did this occur?
The current system lacks interactive tools for real-time candidate engagement.

Why did this occur?
Recruiters are forced to manually find through opportunities and current and personalized messages in bulk.

Why did this occur?
There are no features for **"interact with a resume"** to get a quick, dynamic summary of a candidate's profile.

Why did this occur?
Existing platform lack robust analytics and filters to efficiently identify and fast-track the right talent.

Why did this occur?
Jobs Bank Focus: The underlying technology in current hiring platforms is often optimized for simple keyword matching and basic resume parsing. This system lacks the sophistication to understand the context of a candidate's skills and experience, leading to poor user satisfaction.

Lack of Personalized Skill Development for Students

Why did this occur?
They don't have a clear, data-driven understanding of their strengths and weaknesses.

Why did this occur?
Current resources don't provide **ATS score** or specific resume tips, leaving students to guess what recruiters want.

Why did this occur?
Feedback on quizzes and projects is often generic and not tailored to specific areas where to work on weak areas effectively.

Why did this occur?
There is no single place to see a clear profile of their technical and non-technical skills.

Why did this occur?
Jobs Bank Focus: The lack of an integrated system that uses AI to skills available in a candidate's profile to specific job requirements and provide a clear roadmap for skill development. This results in a disconnected learning experience where students are left to guess which skills are most valuable for their target roles, leading to inefficient learning cycles and a lack of personalized feedback.

Unengaging User Experience

Why did this occur?
The visual design lacks the polish and professionalism of a realistic application.

Why did this occur?
Key features are hard to find because the layout is not intuitive.

Why did this occur?
The contrast and size of important elements are not optimized, making it difficult for user the app effectively.

Why did this occur?
There is a lack of a clear, guided onboarding process, leaving users unsure of where to start.

Why did this occur?
Jobs Bank Focus: The software design philosophy prioritizes functionality over user experience. The UI/UX is often an afterthought, leading to a clunky, unintuitive interface that lacks the polish and professionalism of a realistic application. This results in a poor first impression and a high bounce rate as users find it difficult to navigate the platform.

Isolated and Unsupportive Learning Environment

Why did this occur?
There is no dedicated **community dashboard** for interactive communication.

Why did this occur?
Students lack opportunities to easily connect with and get help from peers and mentors.

Why did this occur?
The learning process is often self-contained and does not encourage collaborative problem-solving.

Why did this occur?
Existing tools do not facilitate real-time collaboration or provide peer feedback on projects and doubts.

Why did this occur?
Jobs Bank Focus: The platform's design is focused on a passive transfer of knowledge from mentor to student, with little emphasis on peer-to-peer learning. The platform's design does not foster a community where students can collaborate, share their progress, and learn from each other's mistakes.

Modifications after feedback

After gathering feedback from multiple students, we have introduced several key features to enhance their experience. These include an AI-powered resume chatbot that provides the ATS score for resumes along with improvement suggestions, a job portal section that allows students to track the stage of their interview process, and a real-time discussion forum where students can connect with peers to share challenges and tips. Following discussions with HR professionals from various companies, we have added an interactive resume chatbot designed specifically for recruiters, enabling them to quickly learn about a candidate's strengths, weaknesses, and other profile details. Additionally, we have implemented a bulk action agent that can automatically send emails to shortlisted students and evaluate multiple resumes in one go. To support both students and HR in making informed decisions, we have integrated analytics, graphs, and KPIs into the platform. Looking ahead, our focus will be on enhancing the UI/UX and streamlining the onboarding process for a smoother, more engaging user journey.

Conflict of Interest

Student Concern vs. Platform Monetization

- **Option 1: Student Concern**
  - **Positive Consequence:** The platform plans to offer all key features like **ATS score and resume tips**, **AI quiz feedback**, and a **community dashboard** for free. This directly addresses student feedback and helps them improve their skills without financial barriers, leading to high user adoption and engagement.
  - **Negative Consequence:** The platform struggles to generate revenue, as it cannot monetize premium features or subscriptions, making it financially unsustainable in the long run.
- **Option 2: Platform Monetization**
  - **Positive Consequence:** The platform generates a stable revenue stream by placing essential features like the **ATS score** and **AI quiz feedback** behind a paywall. This allows the company to invest in product development and marketing, ensuring the platform's long-term viability.
  - **Negative Consequence:** A large number of students, particularly those who are financially constrained, are unable to access the core features needed for their career development. This limits the platform's user base and could lead to negative reviews or a perception that the platform is not accessible.

Desired Result: A hybrid model where core features remain free to attract a large user base, while a premium subscription tier offers advanced features like in-depth career counseling or access to exclusive mentor workshops. This ensures both accessibility and financial viability.

Employer Concern vs. Candidate Transparency

- **Option 1: Employer Concern**
  - **Positive Consequence:** Employers get comprehensive access to a candidate's profile, including a detailed **fit score**, verified projects, and skill analytics. This streamlines the hiring process and helps them find the best-fit candidates more efficiently, leading to high employer satisfaction and repeat business.
  - **Negative Consequence:** Candidates may feel their privacy is violated and lose trust in the platform if they do not have control over who sees their data and how it is used. This could lead to a decline in user sign-ups and data quality.
- **Option 2: Candidate Transparency**
  - **Positive Consequence:** Candidates have full control over their data and can selectively share their profiles with employers. This builds trust and ensures a strong user base, as candidates feel secure and empowered on the platform.
  - **Negative Consequence:** Employers find it difficult to efficiently vet candidates because they have limited access to data. This can lead to a less effective and slower hiring process, potentially causing employers to use other platforms.

Desired Result: A user-centric model where candidates have full control over their data and can choose what information to share with potential employers. This builds trust and ensures data security, while still providing a robust, transparent view of the candidate's skills for recruiters who are given permission to access it.

UI/UX Simplicity vs. Feature Richness

- **Option 1: UI/UX Simplicity**
  - **Positive Consequence:** The platform offers an intuitive and simple user interface that is easy to navigate. This addresses user feedback about being overwhelmed and not knowing where to start, leading to a better initial user experience.
  - **Negative Consequence:** To maintain simplicity, the platform must omit many features that address specific user feedback (e.g., advanced filters, community dashboards), making the application less useful and comprehensive in the long run.
- **Option 2: Feature Richness**
  - **Positive Consequence:** The platform offers a wide range of features (e.g., community dashboards, bulk email, various filters) that directly address user feedback and solve their problems, making the application a comprehensive solution.
  - **Negative Consequence:** The user interface becomes cluttered and complex, leading to a poor user experience. Users find it difficult to navigate and discover key features, which can lead to frustration and lower engagement.

Desired Result: A modular design approach where features are grouped logically and can be accessed easily through a clean, intuitive interface. This could involve a customizable dashboard or a guided onboarding process that helps users discover relevant features without feeling overwhelmed.

Mentors vs. Time Commitment

- **Option 1: Mentor Availability**
  - **Positive Consequence:** Mentors are readily available to students through one-on-one sessions, group sessions, and a chat section for quick doubt clarification. This directly addresses the student's need for consistent, accessible help.
  - **Negative Consequence:** Mentors, who are often busy professionals, become overwhelmed by the constant demand for their time and may disengage from the platform, leading to a shortage of available mentors.
- **Option 2: Mentor Time Commitment**
  - **Positive Consequence:** The platform provides tools that limit a mentor's time commitment, such as scheduled sessions and a system where a community of peers can answer basic questions. This attracts more mentors and ensures their contributions are sustainable.
  - **Negative Consequence:** Students may feel that they are not getting enough personalized attention or immediate help. The limited availability of mentors could lead to frustration and a perception that the mentorship program is not robust.

Desired Result: A structured mentorship system that provides clear boundaries and incentives. This could involve a gamified system that rewards mentors for their contributions and a community-driven model where peers handle basic questions, freeing up mentors for more in-depth guidance.

Link: Jira.

Solve Phase(2)

1. **Developing an Interactive Recruitment Hub:** Creating a dashboard for HR professionals that goes beyond static profiles. This hub will include a **"interact with the resume"** tool for dynamic candidate assessment, **role-based filters** (e.g., Software, UI, Education), and a **bulk email messaging system** to streamline communication with individual candidates.
2. **Enhancing Analytics and Data Visualization:** Integration of a robust analytics engine into the platform to provide HR with more meaningful data. This will include representing candidate information with **graphs and numbers** to offer deeper insights into the applicant pool and help them make more informed hiring decisions.
3. **Implement a Personalized Career Compass:** For students, we need to develop an AI-powered feature that provides an **ATS score and specific resume tips** to improve their job applications. This feature will also offer a clear profile of their **strengths and weaknesses in technical and non-technical areas**, giving them a personalized roadmap for skill development.
4. **Create an AI-Driven Feedback Loop:** Build an AI-powered conversational tool that provides feedback on quizzes and helps students practice and improve on their weak sections. This moves beyond generic feedback to an interactive learning experience.
5. **Launch a Community Dashboard:** To address the need for a collaborative environment, create a **community dashboard** where students can interact, communicate, and share their progress. This feature will foster a supportive ecosystem for peer-to-peer learning and networking.
6. **Transform the UI/UX for a Realistic Feel:** Revamp the application's user interface to improve its aesthetic and functionality. This includes making **UI/UX changes with an increase in size and contrast** at certain places on the application, transforming its feel from rudimentary to a more professional and realistic one.
7. **Structure and Incentivize Mentorship:** Introduce a more structured approach to mentorship, where mentors can easily conduct **one-to-one sessions, group sessions**, and clarify doubts in a dedicated **chat section**. The system will also provide clear incentives to encourage mentors to participate actively.
8. **Improve User Onboarding and Discoverability:** Implement a guided onboarding process to help new users understand where to start. The UI/UX should be designed to improve the discoverability of key features, ensuring users can easily find and utilize the tools they need without frustration.